RSS Digest
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1. llm-tools-datasette 0.1.1
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-18T23:43:09+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/18/llm-tools-datasette/
Release: llm-tools-datasette 0.1.1 When I switched LLM over to httpx2 in LLM 0.33 I forget that this would break any plugins which used httpx without directly depending on it. llm-tools-datasette was one of those plugins, now fixed. Tags: datasette , llm

2. llm-echo 0.5
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-18T23:16:16+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/18/llm-echo/
Release: llm-echo 0.5 I’m working towards a new LLM release, and testing PRs caused me to revisit the llm-echo debug plugin. This plugin provides a "model" which doesn’t involve an LLM at all - it just repeats back the prompts that have been fed to it. The new release now updates the simulated token usage counts to take tool calls, system prompts, and reasoning tokens into account. Example usage: uvx --with llm-echo llm -m echo ’hi there’ -o thinking 1 --usage Outputs: First I consider the prompt, then I decide what to say. { "prompt": "hi there", "system": "", "attachments": [], "stream": true, "previous": [] } Token usage: 2 input, 24 output Tags: llm

3. Tom the Dancing Bug?s Inner Hive, and Harvey Richards, the Greatest Lawyer in the History of Fiction
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-18T22:53:00Z
Link: https://tomthedancingbug.com/the-inner-hive/
Ruben Bolling?s long-running Tom the Dancing Bug is one of my favorite comic strips. I?ve been a huge fan since the early 1990s, when I started reading it in alternative newspapers. (Newspapers were sort of like websites, excepted they were printed daily or weekly. I swear.) Back in 2012 Bolling ? noting that the comic was more widely read than ever yet generating less money than ever ? started a subscription membership called The Inner Hive . I love it. Not just because I?m supporting work that I adore and value, but because the extras that members get are so fun. If you?re even half as big a fan of Tom the Dancing Bug as I am, you should join too . There are several options ? Patreon, MailChimp, Substack ? but in my opinion Patreon is the simplest and the best, and it gets you everything. I was reminded to re-endorse The Inner Hive after I wrote a post last night referencing Harvey Richards , lawyer for children ? one of the comic?s longest running recurring characters. Tom the Dancing Bug?s entire schtick is premised on a wide array of recurring characters and premises, but Richards is probably my favorite. Here?s an early one regarding the doctrine of ?He Who Smelt It, Dealt I...

4. WorkOS AuthKit
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-18T22:45:00Z
Link: https://workos.com/?utm_source=daringfireball&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=q42026
My thanks to WorkOS for sponsoring DF last week. Login looks simple until you?re building password resets, email verification, MFA, social providers, session management, and the enterprise SSO your first big customer asked for last week. WorkOS AuthKit lets you: Offer SSO, MFA, passkeys, passwords, email codes, and social sign-in. Add and remove users automatically with SCIM provisioning. Track who did what with audit logs. Try AuthKit today . ?

5. Verizon Is Going to Charge $10/Month for iPhone Handoff
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-18T22:20:06Z
Link: https://www.verizon.com/about/news/iphone-duo-verizon-offers
Verizon, in a post headlined ?Switch to Verizon and Get the New iPhone Duo Now. No Trade-In Needed.?: Verizon will support iPhone Handoff, giving customers the flexibility to use a single Verizon phone number seamlessly across two compatible iPhone models. Whether using the

pocketable iPhone Duo on the go or iPhone 18 Pro for work, customers can switch active status between devices at any time while keeping full access to Verizon?s 5G network. iPhone Handoff will be available from Verizon for $10/month on compatible iPhones models running iOS 27. First, the word ?now? is doing a lot of work in that headline, given the current January 25 estimate for new Duo orders. Second, we all know Verizon is the most expensive competent carrier in the U.S. (Maybe AT&T is just as expensive, but I said ?competent?.) It feels like a rip that T-Mobile is charging $5/month . Verizon charging double is on-brand but irritating. ?

6. What requirements don’t you have?
Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Mon, 19 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://seangoedecke.com/what-requirements-dont-you-have/
When designing software, the requirements you don?t have are as important as the requirements you do. Identifying what you can compromise on ? what can be slow, or stale, or inflexible ? is usually the key to an elegant design. Elegant systems drop some requirements For instance, take preforking web servers like Unicorn . Because they lack the feature of shared mutable state between server instances, they can run each server in its own process, which provides isolation for free. Because Unicorn specifically ignores the problem of slow client handling 1 , it can queue requests directly on Unix sockets, drastically simplifying the implementation. Because S3 does not support atomic multi-key updates ? you cannot update multiple blobs in a single transaction ? it can store data at the blob level however it chooses. That makes it much faster, since reads and writes don?t have to cross storage partitions, and much easier to scale, since less coordination means fewer sources of truth. StatsD uses UDP by default, which means it doesn?t guarantee that every piece of data you send makes it into storage. In exchange for dropping that requirement, it incurs much less network overhead, which i...

7. Inside the Intel 8087 chip: floating-point addition and subtraction
Source: Ken Shirriff’s blog | Published: 2026-10-18T09:14:00.971-07:00
Link: http://www.righto.com/2026/10/8087-addition-subtraction-microcode.html
In 1980, Intel introduced the 8087, a chip that made floating-point operations much faster in the IBM PC and other systems. Although the 8087 supports advanced operations such as tangents, square roots, and logarithms, this article focuses on basic arithmetic operations: addition and subtraction. The 8087 provided a spectacular speed improvement over the 8086 processor, speeding up addition by a factor of almost 100, and complicated operations by even more. 1 In this article, I examine the 8087’s microcode and circuitry to explain exactly how floating-point addition and subtraction are implemented, including numerous special cases for infinities and other special values. To explore the 8087’s circuitry, I popped the lid off a chip with a chisel and used a microscope to create the high-resolution image below. The microcode ROM is the large rectangular region in the center of the die, holding the 1648 micro-instructions that control the chip. The bottom half of the chip (red box) is the datapath, the circuitry that performs floating-point calculations on 80-bit values. 2 A close-up of the 8087’s datapath, showing functional blocks that are used for addition and subtraction. Click th...

8. Una Watch TOTP - MFA on your wrist!
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Sun, 18 Oct 2026 11:34:08 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/una-watch-totp-mfa-on-your-wrist/
Let’s get this out of the way first - this is a terrible idea! I want my two-factor authentication codes to be easily accessible to me, so I’ve built a watch app which will display them. That’s really convenient for me - but makes for a terrible security posture. Anyone who steals my watch will be able to see my one-time code. If they’re clever, they can decompile the app and find the secret?